FICTIONAL TRAINING ARTIFACT — NOT FILED — NOT LEGAL ADVICE

January 17 message from Leora Benton

To: Naomi Voss; Mira Solis Subject: review requested — sex-based lead assignment pattern

Benton wrote that recorded lead assignments had repeatedly gone to male managers while women did planning and remediation work. She identified Lantern, Hearth, and Juniper, explained that lead credit affected reviews and advancement, and said the pattern appeared sex-based.

She asked Blue Cedar to pause reliance on the lead total, audit assignments for the prior year, and apply a neutral rule. Benton requested preservation of scheduling, project, and scoring data. She said her concern was discrimination, not a preference for a particular client.

Voss acknowledgment and forwarding note

At 4:18 p.m. on January 17, Voss replied that she had received the concern and would send it to human resources. She asked Benton not to alter project records while the review was pending and said current assignments would remain in place for the following week.

Voss's internal forward to Solis stated: "Leora is expressly raising sex discrimination in how lead credit is assigned." Voss attached the 2024 assignment export and noted that several rows listed one manager as planner and another as lead.

Voss did not call the concern insubordination or a performance issue. She asked Solis what communication managers should use while the review proceeded.

Human-resources response and review scope

On January 21, Solis assigned employee-relations reference ER-25-014. She told Benton that the review would compare assignment requests, approved leads, actual field leadership, and use of the lead metric in 2024 reviews.

Solis asked Benton for examples and witnesses by January 24. She reminded Voss that the anti-retaliation policy required human-resources review of any proposed score, duty, or employment change affecting Benton during the review period.

The response did not decide whether discrimination occurred. It confirmed that Blue Cedar understood Benton to be opposing an asserted sex-based practice.

January 24 data follow-up

Benton supplied a table of twelve engagements. For Lantern, Hearth, and Juniper she linked the planning files she authored and the field calendars showing her work. She marked six other rows where women performed substantial remediation but did not receive lead credit.

Benton explained that the 2024 review dashboard counted lead designations without crediting planning substitutions. She proposed either recording joint leads or removing the metric until the source data could be corrected.

She also identified Tessa Wynn and Omar Ibarra as employees who could explain how leads were assigned. Benton did not accuse either employee of wrongdoing; her concern concerned the system and management choices.

January 29 meeting and January 31 closeout note

Solis's meeting note records Benton, Voss, and Solis attending on January 29. Benton restated that the assignment pattern disadvantaged women and asked that any upcoming staffing review use actual work rather than recorded lead labels. Voss agreed the data required reconciliation.

On January 31, Solis wrote that the assignment audit would continue and no final conclusion had been reached. She confirmed that ER-25-014 remained open and that the underlying records were on hold.

The note contains no finance target, RIF model, or manager-selection plan. It records protected opposition and the employer's contemporaneous understanding as of January 31.